Debut

Plan it. Launch it. Grow it.

FOUNDER'S PLAYBOOK: FROM TODAY TO YOUR FIRST 100 CUSTOMERS

Debut Launch Playbook

Who you need, and exactly what to do before, during and after launch: week by week.

Inside this guide

- The 8-week plan and the three go/no-go gates
- Who you need, what they do and what to give them
- Before launch: accounts, deployment, legal, tax, payments
- The pilot, then launch week day by day
- After launch: the first 30, 60 and 90 days
- Runbooks, risks, message templates and a master checklist

Version September 2026. Screens and limits described match Debut at the time of writing; the Pricing page always shows current pl

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1. The launch on one page

Debut is built and tested. What stands between you and paying customers is not code: it is accounts, a live deployment, legal and tax paperwork, real payments, and a handful of real users. This playbook puts those in the right order so nothing blocks you at the last minute.

Phase	When	Main outcome	Lead time to watch
0. Decide	Week 1	Name, prices, niche, budget, launch date and the people you need are settled	None: it is your decisions
1. Accounts and infrastructure	Weeks 1-2	Domain, hosting, database, email, AI key, Razorpay application, monitoring, password vault	Razorpay KYC and email DNS can take days
2. Deploy, test, harden	Weeks 2-3	Staging and production run; all 22 smoke tests pass; backups restored once	Developer availability
3. Legal, tax, payments	Weeks 1-4 (parallel)	Lawyer-approved policies, GST decision, live payments proven with a real Rs transaction	Lawyer and Razorpay approval: start on day 1
Gate A	End of week 4	**Ready for pilot**	
4. Pilot	Weeks 4-6	5 friendly users use it for real; you fix what breaks; you learn what they will pay for	Recruiting pilots
Gate B	End of week 6	**Ready for public launch**	
5. Launch	Weeks 7-8	Signups open; first paying customers; support runs smoothly	
6. After launch	Days 1-90	A weekly rhythm, real metrics, first improvements from customer feedback	

The honest starting point

Built and tested (automated tests, both databases, browser crawl)	Built but never run against the real service	Not built yet
Live Market Pulse (news, trending searches, videos, competitors, rising terms, AI brief), AI web research with sources, accounts, roles, Team Lead, client portal, approvals, Team hub, comments, notifications, digest, 14 industry modes, AI Studio, free and paid plans, API, two-factor login, reports, installable phone app, feedback inbox, launch metrics	Razorpay live payments and webhooks; real email sending (SMTP); S3 image storage; the daily digest cron; **every live data source (news, YouTube, trends, web research)**; the phone install on real devices	Direct posting to LinkedIn/Instagram; a customer's own Meta and Google Analytics data; mid-subscription plan changes; a native app; single sign-on; suspending an abusive workspace from the admin

Why this matters

Everything in the middle column is where launch-week surprises come from. That is why Phases 2 and 3 exist and why the pilot must include a real, small payment and a real email.

2. Who you need

You do not need a big team. You need one developer, one lawyer, one accountant, a few friendly users, and your own time. Everyone else is optional.

Who	Why you need them	When	Effort	What to give them
You (founder / product owner)	Decisions, pilot relationships, selling, first-line support, final approvals. You are the platform admin.	All phases	About 10-15 hours a week before launch; daily during launch week	Everything below
Developer / DevOps (freelance, 1 person)	Deploy Debut, connect payments, email and storage, set up backups and monitoring, fix bugs, keep it secure and updated	Weeks 1-4, then on call	Roughly 5-8 working days to deploy and harden, then 1-2 days a month	The zip, the Developer Deployment Guide, the access list in section 3
Lawyer (startup / technology / IP)	Terms, Privacy Policy, Refund policy, data-protection duties (India's DPDP Act), trademark for the name	Weeks 1-4	One-time, 1-2 weeks elapsed	The three policy pages (they are templates), your company details, the list of vendors that touch customer data
Accountant / CA	Business registration if you have none, GST decision and registration, how to invoice, TDS, how Razorpay payouts are booked	Weeks 1-4, then monthly	Setup 1-2 weeks; then monthly filings	Your prices, plan list, business bank details
Designer (optional)	Polish the logo, landing visuals, social templates, launch graphics	Weeks 3-6	2-4 days	The app icon, the lavender palette, the name Debut
Pilot users (5 real people)	The only way to find what real customers stumble on	Weeks 4-6	1 hour to onboard, 15 minutes a week each	A personal invitation and a founder discount (section 5)
Support helper (later)	Answer emails and messages so you can keep building and selling	When you have about 20 paying workspaces	5-10 hours a week	The support macros in section 8 and access to the admin
Security tester (optional)	A quick outside penetration test before you promote widely	Before public launch or at 50+ customers	2-5 days	A staging copy and permission in writing

Where to find them

- **Developer:** ask for someone who has deployed Flask/Python apps with PostgreSQL, Docker and payment webhooks. Ask for two references, and to see one payment integration they shipped. Give them the tests first: *if they can run all 70 tests, they can run the app.*
- **Lawyer and CA:** ask your network for startup-friendly ones; get a fixed-fee quote in writing and a delivery date. Send them the policy pages together with a short description of what Debut does.
- **Pilot users:** your own network, alumni and college contacts, LinkedIn connections, and agencies you already know.

Rough first-quarter budget (planning ranges in rupees; get real quotes)

Item	Planning range	Notes
Domain	Rs 700-1,500 per year	.com or .in; buy it yourself so you own it
Hosting and database	Rs 1,500-5,000 per month	One web service plus PostgreSQL at pilot scale; check current prices at your provider
Email sending	Rs 0-1,500 per month	Most providers have a free tier that covers a pilot
Error monitoring and uptime checks	Rs 0	Free tiers are enough at the start
News API and YouTube key	Rs 0 for the pilot; a paid news plan later	Free tiers exist; check current limits and prices before you scale
AI usage (Anthropic)	Variable: you control it	Every generation costs you a small amount. Free workspaces get 5 credits a month. Set **AI_DAILY_CAP** during launch week and watch the cost in your Anthropic dashboard. Live web research costs more per answer
Payment gateway fees	A percentage of each payment	Commonly around 2 percent plus GST for domestic payments; UPI and other methods differ. Check Razorpay's current rate card
Developer	Rs 40,000-1,50,000 one-time, then a small retainer	Depends heavily on experience; get 2-3 quotes
Lawyer	Rs 15,000-60,000 one-time	Terms, Privacy, Refund policy, DPDP checklist; trademark filing extra
Accountant	Setup Rs 3,000-10,000, then Rs 2,000-5,000 per month	GST registration, monthly returns, bookkeeping
Trademark	Official fee in the low thousands per class, plus attorney fee	Software / SaaS classes; your lawyer decides which
Designer (optional)	Rs 10,000-40,000	Launch graphics and templates
Realistic total for the first 3 months	**About Rs 1.5-4 lakh**	Lower if you do more yourself; higher with a security test and paid marketing

3. Phase 0 and 1: decide, then open your accounts

Phase 0: decisions only you can make (week 1)

- [ ] **Trademark search for Debut** (IP India public search) before you spend on branding. The name checks so far were web searches only.
- [ ] **Legal entity:** proprietorship, LLP or Pvt Ltd? Ask your CA. Razorpay needs business details and a bank account in that name.
- [ ] **Prices and GST:** Razorpay charges the plan amount exactly. Decide whether prices include GST (set PRICE_NOTE to *incl. GST*) or GST is added on top (create plans at price x 1.18). Then edit the prices in **config.py** and create matching Razorpay plans.
- [ ] **Who is Debut for first?** Pick one or two segments (for example personal brands and small agencies). Your first 20 customers should look alike.
- [ ] **Free plan limits:** keep the defaults for now (1 seat, 100 records, 3 boards, 5 AI credits). Every free workspace costs you a little.
- [ ] **Launch date and pilot list:** write down the date for public launch (about 8 weeks out) and the names of 8 people you will invite to the pilot (you want 5 to say yes).
- [ ] **Support:** choose a support email address, a phone or WhatsApp number, and the hours you will answer. These appear on the Contact page.
- [ ] **Budget and AI ceiling:** decide how much you will spend per month on AI at launch and set the daily cap (section 9).

Phase 1: accounts and infrastructure (weeks 1-2)

Open every account with a **business email you control** (for example founder@yourdomain), turn on **two-factor login on each one**, and store the logins in a **password manager** that your developer can be given a shared folder in. Never send secrets in chat.

Account	Owner	What you do	Notes
Domain name	You	Buy it in your own name. Point it to the host when your developer asks.	Also reserve matching social handles
Business email (support@, founder@)	You	Set up mailboxes with your domain	Needed for Razorpay, legal notices and customers
Hosting (for example Render) and PostgreSQL	You create, developer configures	Create the account and add your developer as a team member	Ask for automatic database backups to be switched on
Email sending (SES, Resend, Postmark or Brevo)	You + developer	Verify your domain; add SPF, DKIM and DMARC records	Without this, verification, reset and invite emails land in spam
Anthropic API key	You	Create a key for Debut and set a monthly spend limit in their console	Give the key only to the developer; never share it in email

Account	Owner	What you do	Notes
Razorpay	You	Apply now: KYC takes days. Start in Test Mode.	Section 4
GitHub (private repository)	You	Create a private repo and invite your developer	Never commit the .env file
Error monitoring (Sentry) and uptime monitor	Developer	Create free accounts; alert to your phone	Alert if /health fails for 2 minutes
Image storage (S3 or R2), optional	Developer	Only if your host has no persistent disk	Keep the bucket private
YouTube Data API key (optional)	Developer	Google Cloud: enable YouTube Data API v3 and create a key	Adds trending videos to Market Pulse
News API (GNews or NewsData), before you scale	You	Create an account and choose a plan	Licensed news source; the free Google feed is fine for the pilot only
Web search in the Anthropic console	You	Enable web search for your organisation	Needed for AI live research; searches cost extra

4. Phase 2 and 3: deploy, test, and make it legal

Phase 2: deploy, test, harden (weeks 2-3): developer leads

1. The developer runs the automated tests (63 should pass) and follows the **Developer Deployment Guide** to deploy a **staging** copy, then production.
2. Set every environment variable in the guide, including **SECRET_KEY**, **APP_URL**, **ADMIN_EMAILS** and the business details (phone, address, grievance officer).
3. **You sign up first** with your admin email, verify it, and turn on two-factor login. In production the admin area stays hidden until you do.
4. Run the **23-step smoke test** from the guide (sign-up, verification email, uploads, invites, roles, approvals, client portal, billing in Test Mode, cancel, export, delete, support view).
5. **Prove email works:** verification, password reset and an invite must arrive in a normal inbox, not spam. Check the daily digest by running it once.
6. **Prove backups work:** take a backup, restore it into a scratch database, log in to a staging copy and confirm the data. Do this once before launch and put a monthly reminder in your calendar.
7. Switch on monitoring alerts and confirm the developer receives a test alert.
8. Set **AI_DAILY_CAP** to your launch budget (for example 300 credits a day) and confirm AI stops politely when it is reached.
9. **Check the live data:** open Market Pulse, press Refresh now, read Notes on sources, and run one AI live-research task. This is the first time those feeds run for real.

Phase 3: legal, tax and payments (weeks 1-4, in parallel)

Task	Who	Done when
Terms, Privacy Policy, Refund and cancellation policy reviewed and edited	Lawyer	Lawyer's approved text is pasted into the three pages and 'TEMPLATE' banners are removed
Data-protection basics (India's DPDP Act): consent wording on the lead form, a named grievance officer, a way to handle access and deletion requests, a breach response plan, the list of vendors that process customer data (hosting, email, payments, AI provider)	Lawyer + you	You can answer 'who has my data, why, and how do I delete it' in one page
Advertising rules for influencer and promotion features (for example ASCI disclosure guidance)	Lawyer	A short note on the Discover Influencers and Promotions pages if the lawyer advises it
Business registration and bank account in the business name	CA	Documents ready for Razorpay
GST decision and registration; how invoices are issued	CA	You know whether to register now, and each customer payment produces a compliant receipt or invoice
Razorpay live account: business documents, website with Terms, Privacy, Refund, Contact and Pricing pages, bank details	You + CA	Live Key ID and Secret issued
Create 3 live Razorpay plans (Starter, Team, Agency) with the exact prices, and a live webhook	Developer	Test Mode flow passes first (subscribe, pay, cancel, failed payment); then the same on Live
One real payment: subscribe with your own card for the smallest plan, confirm the plan activates, then refund it	You + developer	Plan flips to paid; webhook shows 200 in Razorpay; refund completes
Trademark application for Debut	Lawyer	Application filed (approval takes much longer; filing is what matters at launch)

Razorpay reviews your website

The app already has the pages a payment gateway looks for: **Pricing, Terms, Privacy, Refund and cancellation, and Contact**. Fill in the business-details settings first (company name, address, phone, grievance officer) so those pages show real information when they review it.

Gate A: ready for the pilot

- [ ] Production site loads on your domain with HTTPS; a fresh sign-up works end to end.
- [ ] All 23 smoke tests pass, and the 63 automated tests pass on the production database type.
- [ ] Verification, reset, invite and digest emails reach real inboxes.
- [ ] A backup has been restored successfully once.
- [ ] A Test-Mode payment worked, and the plan of a test workspace flipped correctly.
- [ ] Policy pages carry your real business details (approved text may still be in progress; do not take real payments until it is).
- [ ] Monitoring alerts reach your phone. Your admin account has two-factor on.
- [ ] You have a support email address and you check it.

5. Phase 4: the pilot (weeks 4-6)

The pilot is five real people using Debut for real work. Its job is to find what breaks and what they would pay for, not to get praise.

Who to recruit

- **2 personal brands** (a founder, consultant, coach or creator).
- **2 small agencies or freelancers with a team** (use the agency guide; give one of them a client in the portal).
- **1 business in a niche mode** (for example D2C, hospitality or FMCG).
- Offer each a **founding-customer deal**: free use during the pilot and a discount on their first paid months if they stay. Keep it simple and put it in writing.

How to run each pilot user (about 1 hour to start)

1. **30-minute onboarding call.** Watch them sign up. Do not help until they are stuck. Write down every hesitation.
2. Send the right guide (personal brands or agencies) and ask them to finish the **Get started** checklist in their first week.
3. **Weekly 15-minute check-in:** what did you do, what confused you, what did you wish it did, would you pay for this and how much?
4. Ask them to use the **Send feedback** button for anything odd. You read the **Feedback inbox** in the admin every morning and reply within a day.
5. At the end of week 2, ask directly: *If this cost the price on our Pricing page, would you subscribe today? If not, what is missing?*

What to measure during the pilot

Question	Where to look	Healthy sign
Did they set it up on their own?	Your observation on the onboarding call	Sign-up to first saved content item in under 15 minutes
Do they come back?	Admin > Launch metrics: workspaces active in the last 7 days	At least 3 of 5 active every week
Where do they get stuck?	Feedback inbox and your call notes	Same problem reported twice gets fixed this week
Would they pay?	Your direct question in week 2	At least 2 of 5 say yes at your prices
Do payments and emails work for real?	One pilot user pays a real, small amount; you refund it after	Plan flips, receipt arrives, refund completes

Gate B: ready for public launch

- [ ] No data-loss or security bug is open. Every bug reported by two or more pilot users is fixed.
- [ ] At least 3 of 5 pilots are active every week, and at least 2 would pay at your prices.
- [ ] A real live payment and a refund have been completed.
- [ ] Lawyer-approved Terms, Privacy and Refund text is live.
- [ ] You have 2 short testimonials or case studies with permission, and screenshots for launch content.
- [ ] Support routine is defined (section 7), and you have the macros ready (section 8).
- [ ] You know your first-month targets (section 7) and where to read them in the admin.

6. Launch week, day by day (weeks 7-8)

Public launch means opening sign-ups and telling people. Keep the plan boring and the checklist strict. Day 0 is the day sign-ups open.

Day	Do this	Who
Day -7	Feature freeze: only bug fixes from now on. Tell your developer the launch date and that they are on call for 10 days.	You
Day -5	Write and schedule launch content: a founder story post, a 60-second demo video or screen recording, 3 screenshots, and the pilot testimonials.	You (+ designer)
Day -3	Final regression: run all tests, redo the 22-step smoke test on production, check the Test-Mode and live payment settings, check that **MAINTENANCE** is off. Take a fresh backup.	Developer
Day -2	Message your waitlist and pilot users with the date. Prepare the support macros. Set the AI daily cap for launch week.	You
Day -1	Rest. Confirm alerts reach your phone. Check that support email and WhatsApp work. Agree who covers what.	You + developer
Day 0 (launch)	Morning: post the launch content; email your list; message 20 people personally. Then every 2 hours: check **Admin > Launch metrics**, the error monitor and the Feedback inbox. Reply to every message within 4 hours.	You

Day	Do this	Who
Day 0 (evening)	Read all feedback. Fix anything that blocks sign-up or payment tonight. Note the top 5 questions people asked.	You + developer
Day +1 to +3	15-minute daily stand-up: sign-ups, activations, errors, payments, feedback. Personally welcome each new sign-up who looks like your target customer. Ship small fixes daily.	You + developer
Day +3	Check the **Trials ending in the next 3 days** list in Admin and message those owners personally (section 8 has a template).	You
Day +5	Publish a second piece of content: what you learned in the first week, or a customer story.	You
Day +7	Review the week: numbers, top bugs, top requests. Decide the next two improvements. Thank pilot users publicly if they agree.	You + developer

Where to announce (start where your first 20 customers are)

- **Your own LinkedIn** (personal brand is your first audience) and Instagram.
- **Your alumni and college networks** and the professional groups you already belong to.
- **Marketing and founder communities** on WhatsApp, Slack and LinkedIn groups: share the free plan and what you learned, not a sales pitch.
- **Direct messages to 20 people** who match your first segment, offering to set them up personally.
- **Pilot users:** ask each for one introduction.

> **Do not launch on a Friday evening**
>
> Choose a Tuesday to Thursday morning so you and your developer are around for the next two days. If something serious breaks, set **MAINTENANCE=1** to show a friendly page while it is fixed; the health check and payment webhook keep working.

7. After launch: days 1 to 90

Your rhythm

When	Time	What
Every day	20 min	Read the Feedback inbox and support email. Glance at Market Pulse for sources that failed. Check Admin > Launch metrics (sign-ups, active workspaces, AI credits used against the cap). Check the error monitor. Reply to every message within one working day.
Every Monday	60 min	Review last week's numbers, top 3 bugs and top 3 requests. Choose what the developer ships this week. Message trials ending in the next 3 days.
Every month	2 hours	Restore-test the latest backup. Review costs (hosting, AI, email). Update dependencies with your developer. Send GST and accounting documents to your CA. Interview two customers and one who left.
Every quarter	Half a day	Review prices and plan limits against real use. Review the risk table (section 9). Decide the next big feature from what customers asked for.

The numbers to watch (and where to read them)

Number	Where	A useful early signal (rule of thumb, not a promise)
New users and workspaces	Admin > Launch metrics	Steady growth week over week; sudden spikes of similar emails mean spam
Active workspaces in 7 days	Admin > Launch metrics	About 4 in 10 new workspaces still active in their first week
New subscriptions and MRR	Admin tiles	First 5 paying customers in the first 30 days; early freemium tools often convert a low single-digit percentage of active users
Trials ending soon	Admin list	You contact each personally before the trial ends
AI credits today and last 30 days	Admin > Launch metrics and your Anthropic console	Well below the daily cap; cost per active workspace steady
Open feedback	Admin > Feedback inbox	Nothing older than 3 days unanswered
Downtime	Uptime monitor	No outage longer than 10 minutes
Cancellations and their reasons	Razorpay dashboard and a short exit message	Every cancellation gets a personal question: 'What was missing?'

First 30, 60 and 90 days

Period	Goal	Actions
Days 1-30	First 5 paying customers; fix the sharp edges	Onboard every sign-up who fits your niche. Ship fixes daily. Collect 3 testimonials. Keep the daily and Monday routine.
Days 31-60	Repeatable acquisition; retention	Publish 2 customer stories. Write the three most-asked answers into the Help page or guides. Start a referral ask at day 30 of every customer. Add a support helper if you pass about 20 paying workspaces.
Days 61-90	Decide the roadmap from evidence	Rank customer requests. Likely first candidates: direct connectors (Meta and Google Analytics), more of the client portal (reports, invoices), and mid-subscription plan changes. Review prices. Consider a light security test before you scale promotion.

Ongoing obligations (not optional)

- **Privacy requests:** acknowledge within 2 days and resolve within 30 days. Customers can export data and delete their workspace themselves; help anyone who cannot.
- **Monthly GST and accounting** with your CA. **Keep policies current** whenever you change plans, prices or features.
- **Security hygiene:** two-factor on every account, a leaver checklist for anyone who had access, updates applied monthly, backups restore-tested monthly.
- **Trademark follow-up:** respond to any objection notices on time.

8. Runbooks and message templates

Runbooks: if something goes wrong

Problem	Do this
The site is down	1) Check the host's status page and your uptime alert. 2) Ask your developer to look at the logs and restart. 3) If it will take more than a few minutes, post a short note on your LinkedIn and reply to customers. 4) Afterwards write down what happened and how to prevent it.
Payments are failing or a plan did not switch	1) Look at Razorpay's webhook log: a 400 means a secret mismatch; no delivery means the URL is wrong. 2) Fix the plan manually in **Admin > Set plan** so the customer is not blocked. 3) Reply to the customer and apologise. 4) Ask the developer to fix the cause.
A customer asks to delete their data	They can do it themselves in Account > Danger zone (owner only), or you confirm identity by email and ask your developer to delete the workspace. Reply in writing within the promised time.
Suspected security breach	1) Ask the developer to contain it (rotate SECRET_KEY, database password, API keys; switch on MAINTENANCE if needed). 2) Preserve logs. 3) **Call your lawyer at once**: the DPDP Act has duties to notify the regulator and affected people. 4) Tell affected customers plainly what happened.
AI costs spike	1) Lower **AI_DAILY_CAP** immediately. 2) Look at the AI usage in Admin and your Anthropic console. 3) If it is abuse, block the workspace manually (see limitations) and require verified email (already required).
A deploy is risky or a migration is running	Set **MAINTENANCE=1**, deploy, test as admin, then set it back to 0. Take a backup first.
You need to restore from backup	Restore into a scratch database first, check it, then repoint the app. Practise this monthly so it is not new on the worst day.
A customer cannot log in (lost phone)	They use a recovery code. If they have none, ask your developer to run the reset-2fa command for their email after you verify identity.

Message templates you can copy

Pilot invitation (WhatsApp or email)

Hi [name], I'm launching Debut, a workspace that helps [personal brands / agencies] plan content, get approvals and report results in one place. I'm inviting five people to use it free for the next few weeks and tell me honestly what works and what doesn't. It takes 30 minutes to set up together. Would you be open to it? If it's useful, you'll get a founding-customer discount later.

Launch post (LinkedIn)

I've been building something for [X months]: Debut. It helps [who] plan, launch and grow their brand: content calendar, an idea bank for your industry, AI drafts in your voice, team approvals and a private portal for clients. It has a free plan forever. Here's what I learned building it: [1 short story]. Try it and tell me what's missing: [link].

Welcome message to a new sign-up (send personally)

Hi [name], I'm [your name], founder of Debut. Saw you signed up: welcome! What are you hoping to use it for? If you tell me, I'll point you to the two features that matter most for that, and I'm happy to do a 15-minute setup call.

Trial ending in 3 days

Hi [name], your Debut trial ends on [date]. After that your workspace continues on the free plan, and nothing is deleted. If [feature they used most] has been useful, the [plan] plan keeps it on. Anything I can help with before then?

Exit question after a cancellation

Hi [name], thanks for trying Debut. Could you tell me in one line what was missing or didn't work? It helps me decide what to build next. Your data stays available for export any time.

Support reply skeleton

Hi [name], thanks for telling us. I've looked at [what they reported]. [Answer or fix, in plain words, with the exact menu path]. Let me know if that solves it. If not, reply here and I'll stay on it until it does.

9. Risks and how to handle them

Risk	How likely / how bad	What you do about it
Live payments or webhooks behave differently from Test Mode	Likely at first / high	Prove a real payment, refund and cancellation before launch (Gate A and B). Keep Admin > Set plan as a manual fallback.
Emails land in spam	Likely if DNS is skipped / high	Verify domain with SPF, DKIM, DMARC; test with a Gmail and an Outlook address; watch bounce rates.
AI costs exceed your budget	Medium / high	AI needs a verified email; monthly credits per plan; use AI_DAILY_CAP during launch; check the Anthropic console weekly.
Fake or spam sign-ups	Medium / low-medium	Sign-up and login rate limits exist; watch the daily sign-up chart; AI is blocked until email is verified.
A data leak between customers	Low (tested) / very high	Automated tests cover isolation for every role including clients. Do not disable them. Consider an outside security test before wide promotion.
Legal or compliance gap (DPDP, advertising rules, GST)	Medium / high	Lawyer and CA involvement in Phase 3; policies live before real payments; grievance officer named.
Depending on one developer	High / high	Keep the code in your own GitHub, secrets in your vault, and the deployment guide current. Ask for a written handover note each month.

Risk	How likely / how bad	What you do about it
Backups exist but do not restore	Medium / very high	Restore-test before launch and monthly.
You run out of time for support	High after launch / medium	Keep daily 20-minute routine; use macros; add a support helper at about 20 paying workspaces.
Third-party data terms (news feeds, trends, video)	Medium / medium	Fine for a small pilot with links back to publishers. Before scaling or charging, switch to a licensed news API (GNews or NewsData) and have your lawyer review the sources you keep.
Competitors with more features	Certain / medium	Win a niche: personal brands, small agencies, Indian industries. Listen to customers before adding features.

10. Master checklist

Print this or copy it into your task app. Owner tags: [You], [Dev], [Lawyer], [CA].

Before launch

- [ ] [You] Trademark search for Debut; decide entity, prices, GST treatment, first segment, launch date, pilot list, support details.
- [ ] [You] Buy domain and business email; open hosting, database, email, Anthropic, Razorpay, GitHub, monitoring accounts with two-factor; create the password vault.
- [ ] [You] Set the business details (company name, address, phone, grievance officer) in the settings.
- [ ] [Dev] Deploy staging and production; set all environment variables; run 70 tests; run the 23-step smoke test.
- [ ] [You] Sign up as admin, verify email, turn on two-factor, confirm the Admin area opens.
- [ ] [Dev] Prove email (verification, reset, invite, digest) and the daily digest schedule.
- [ ] [Dev] Take a backup and restore it once; add a monthly reminder.
- [ ] [Dev] Connect monitoring alerts; set AI_DAILY_CAP; confirm MAINTENANCE works.
- [ ] [Lawyer] Approved Terms, Privacy, Refund text and DPDP checklist; file the trademark.
- [ ] [CA] GST decision, registration if needed, invoicing method; documents for Razorpay.
- [ ] [You + Dev] Razorpay Test Mode flow, then Live keys, live plans and live webhook; one real payment and refund.
- [ ] [You] Recruit 5 pilot users and run the pilot; pass Gate B.

During launch (days -7 to +7)

- [ ] [You] Feature freeze; launch content ready; waitlist told; support macros ready.
- [ ] [Dev] Final regression, fresh backup, MAINTENANCE off, on call for 10 days.
- [ ] [You] Launch Tuesday to Thursday morning; check metrics and feedback every 2 hours on day 0; reply within 4 hours.
- [ ] [You + Dev] Daily 15-minute stand-up for the first three days; ship small fixes daily.
- [ ] [You] Message every trial ending in 3 days personally; publish a second post on day 5; weekly review on day 7.

After launch

- [ ] [You] Daily: feedback inbox, support email, metrics, error monitor. Weekly: numbers, top bugs and requests, choose what ships. Monthly: costs, restore test, updates, GST documents, customer and churn interviews.
- [ ] [You] Get 3 testimonials by day 30; start the referral ask; decide the roadmap by day 90 from evidence.
- [ ] [Lawyer + You] Keep policies, vendor list and grievance process current; respond to privacy requests within 30 days.
- [ ] [Dev] Apply security updates monthly; hand over a short written note each month; keep the deployment guide current.
- [ ] [You] Hire a support helper at about 20 paying workspaces; consider a security test before scaling promotion.

You are closer than it feels

The product is built, tested and documented. The remaining work is a checklist of ordinary steps done in the right order, with real people watching. Start with Phase 0 this week, and send the Developer Deployment Guide to your developer today so their availability is confirmed early.